

FIONA CHEN

fionachen@g.harvard.edu

Cell 512-461-8414

<https://fion.ac/>



HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Littauer Center
1805 Cambridge St
Cambridge MA 02138

Placement Director: Myrto Kalouptsidi
Placement Director: Oleg Itskhoki
Administrative Director: Brenda Piquet

myrto@g.harvard.edu
itskhoki@fas.harvard.edu
bpiquet@harvard.edu

617-496-0832
617-495-2144
617-495-8927

Education

Harvard University

Ph.D. in Business Economics, 2021 to 2027 (expected)

Visiting Student, Stanford Digital Economy Lab, 2026

M.A. in Business Economics, 2023

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

B.S. in Mathematics and in Economics, 2021

Fields

Labor Economics

Digital Economics and AI

References

Lawrence Katz
Harvard University
lkatz@harvard.edu

Jesse Shapiro
Harvard University
jesse.m.shapiro@gmail.com

Amanda Pallais
Harvard University
apallais@fas.harvard.edu

Erik Brynjolfsson
Stanford University
erik.brynjolfsson@gmail.com

Affiliations

Stanford Digital Economy Lab
Opportunity Insights

2026-
2021-

Job Market Paper

Artificial Intelligence in the Firm, with James Stratton

How do generative AI technologies affect productivity, output, and employment? We study the impacts of AI coding assistants and agents on software engineering work, using a novel proprietary dataset from an engineering analytics platform, covering 300 million work events – GitHub coding activity, Jira issues, and Google Calendar events – from 718 firms. We utilize a staggered difference-in-differences strategy, exploiting variation in firm-level adoption timing of AI coding assistants and agents. Both technologies lead to significant increases in coding productivity. However, productivity gains do not pass through to changes in software output or employment. For AI agents, code review becomes the bottleneck: the length of the review process increases, reflecting both a buildup in the review queue and more intensive review – AI-generated code attracts higher rates of change requests and more reviewer comments. In response, firms reallocate labor towards code review.

Papers in Progress

AI as a Career Advisor, with Katelyn Cranney and Leo Saenger

The Labor Market Effects of AI: Current Evidence and Future Directions, with Erik Brynjolfsson and Bharat Chandar

Task Assignment and Career Advancement, with James Stratton

Policy Papers

Shaping the Future of Work: Generative AI, Inequality, and Opportunity, The Social Finance Institute: Workforce and Economic Mobility Papers, 17 December 2025

Research Assistance	Harvard, RA to Winnie van Dijk, <i>Concentration in Rental Housing Markets</i>	2022-23
	MIT, RA to Amy Finkelstein, <i>Blueprints for Universal Health Coverage</i>	2019-20
	MIT, RA to David Autor, <i>New Frontiers: The Origins and Evolving Content of New Work</i>	2019-20
	MIT, RA to Frank Schilbach, <i>The Economic Consequences of Increasing Sleep Among the Urban Poor</i>	2017-19
Employment & Service	MIT Corporation (Board of Trustees), <i>Trustee</i>	2021-26
	Social Finance, <i>Research Fellow</i>	2025-26
	Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco, <i>Financial Supervision Intern</i>	2019
Fellowships & Awards	Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Grant	2026
	Stripe Economics of AI Fellowship	2025
	J. Robert Beyster Fellowship, Study of Employee Ownership and Profit Sharing	2025
	James M. and Cathleen D. Stone Fellowship in Inequality and Wealth Concentration	2023
	Opportunity Insights Doctoral Fellowship	2021
	Paul and Daisy Soros Fellowship for New Americans	2021
	Phi Beta Kappa	2021
	Burchard Scholarship	2019
Teaching	Harvard Medical School, Causal Inference in Economics and Medicine, <i>Josh Angrist</i>	2025
	Harvard, ECON 980B Education in the Economy, <i>Claudia Goldin and Lawrence Katz</i>	2024
	Harvard, ECON 2330 History and Human Capital (PhD), <i>Claudia Goldin and Lawrence Katz</i>	2024
	Harvard, ECON 980X The Economics of Work and Family, <i>Claudia Goldin</i>	2023
	Harvard, Math Camp: Econometrics (PhD)	2021
	MIT, 14.75 Political Economy and Economic Development, <i>Benjamin Olken</i>	2020
	MIT, 14.13 Psychology and Economics, <i>Frank Schilbach and Dmitry Taubinsky</i>	
Seminars & Conferences	Harvard INFORMS MSOM (Scheduled), INFORMS (Scheduled), Stanford University Economics, Stanford University Digital Economy Lab, Google, MIT FutureTech, Society of Labor Economists	2026
	UC Berkeley Artificial Intelligence Research (BAIR) Laboratory, MIT Computer Science and AI Laboratory (CSAIL), Opportunity Insights Conference, University of Chicago Machine Learning in Economics Conference, Harvard Kennedy School Stone Scholar Symposium	2025
Languages	English (Native), Mandarin (Conversational), French (Basic)	
Software	Python, R, Stata, SQL	